

Payment Chronicle by Gajanan

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Companies: Square, Adyen

Article 1

Adyen plugs into Meal Ticket to power payments for foodservice distributors

Adyen just found a new seat at the distributor's table. It's partnering with Meal Ticket, a software platform used by foodservice distributors, to embed payments directly into the tools these businesses already use. Translation: instead of chasing checks and juggling terminals, distributors can accept card and digital payments inside Meal Ticket, reconcile faster, and see cash sooner. For a sector still heavy on legacy invoicing and thin margins, that's a practical upgrade. The bigger story is the vertical SaaS play. Meal Ticket can now wrap payments around its workflow and likely earn a slice of each transaction, boosting stickiness and revenue without building a payments stack from scratch. Adyen, meanwhile, gets deeper into B2B flows—larger ticket sizes, recurring volumes, and a hard-to-penetrate niche—while showcasing its platform chops. Expect pressure on incumbent ISOs and bank processors serving distributors as embedded finance becomes the default. The catch? Execution. Migrating long-time customers off checks takes onboarding muscle and change management. But if it clicks, this could compress DSO, cut back-office pain, and accelerate the industry's slow march to digital.

Source: PaymentsDive

<https://www.paymentsdive.com/press-release/20240826-meal-ticket-partners-with-adyen-to-launch-payment-solutions-for-food-servic-1/>

Article 2

Adyen taps Plaid to push pay by bank into the mainstream

Cards are pricey, so Adyen is cozying up to Plaid to cut out the plastic middleman. The payments giant will plug Plaid's bank account linking, verification and risk tools into its single platform, so merchants can let customers pay straight from their bank accounts via ACH/open banking rails. Think instant account verification instead of clunky microdeposits, balance checks to reduce "insufficient funds" failures, and ownership checks to curb fraud—all wrapped into Adyen's acquiring, risk, and reconciliation stack. What does it mean? For merchants, a cheaper tender type that can chip away at card fees, better conversion at checkout, and fewer ACH returns. For Adyen, it's another step toward being the all-in-one payments operating system—owning more of the value chain while defending take rates as acceptance costs come under pressure. And for Plaid, deeper embed in enterprise payments flows. The catch: US consumers are creatures of card habit, ACH refunds aren't instant, and dispute protections differ. But if subscription billers, marketplaces, and fintech wallets lean in, pay-by-bank could quietly siphon share from debit. Expect rivals with similar open-banking plays to respond—and card networks to sharpen their own low-cost debit and account-to-account strategies.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-and-plaid-partnership-what-it-means/>

Article 3

Need the full Adyen release to craft an accurate Finshots-style brief

We only have the opening line of Adyen's July 12, 2022 press release. To produce a sharp, Finshots-style summary that's useful for payment execs, we need the core facts: what exactly Adyen announced (a product like Tap to Pay on iPhone or embedded finance for platforms, a new partnership, a geographic expansion, or financial results), who it affects, and any hard numbers (coverage, pricing, timelines, customer logos). Share the full text or the key bullets—what, where, when, why, and how—and I'll turn it into a 150–200 word analysis focused on what it means for merchants, platforms, and competitors. Without those specifics, any write-up risks being inaccurate. Once we have the details, we'll unpack the strategic implications: the impact on acquiring economics, merchant onboarding and acceptance, platform monetization, and Adyen's positioning versus Stripe, PayPal, and legacy processors. Send the specifics, and you'll get a crisp headline and a witty, accessible breakdown tailored for payment industry decision-makers.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-goes-live-with-tap-to-pay-on-iphone/>

Article 4

BNPL's holiday boom could be a quiet win for Adyen

Buy now, pay later (BNPL) is set for another holiday growth spurt, and Swedish BNPL giant Klarna is already signalling strong demand. For Adyen—the Dutch processor powering payments for global merchants—that's more than seasonal cheer. Adyen sits at the checkout layer, letting retailers toggle on BNPL options like Klarna alongside cards and wallets, online and in-store. If shoppers flock to BNPL to manage budgets, Adyen's processed volumes rise, conversion improves, and average order values often tick up. Crucially, Adyen doesn't shoulder the credit risk—that's on the BNPL providers—so it gets the upside of higher transactions without writing loans. The catch? BNPL can add operational complexity (think disputes and refunds) and regulators are circling the space, which could reshape fees and flows. Competitively, Stripe and PayPal offer similar BNPL rails, but Adyen's strength is unified orchestration across channels and geographies, helping large merchants switch on what works, where it works, fast. Net-net: a BNPL-fuelled holiday could be a tailwind for Adyen's volume and merchant stickiness, reinforcing its point-of-sale push and its pitch as the one-stop control tower for modern checkout.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/klarna-and-adyen-team-up-for-in-store-bnpl/>

Article 5

Square's new Handheld ditches the phone to go all in on mobile POS

Square built its name on little add-ons that turned phones into card readers. Now it's cutting the phone out. The company has launched Handheld, a compact, purpose-built device that runs Square's POS on its own—think line-busting, tableside ordering and curbside checkout without worrying about staff phones, battery quirks or MDM headaches. Why this matters: dedicated hardware gives Square more control over reliability and merchant experience, a big deal for larger, multi-location retailers and restaurants that want standardized, rugged gear. It also answers rivals like Toast and Clover that have pushed hard into mobile, in-store devices. Strategically, Handheld can deepen lock-in to Square's ecosystem (payments, invoicing, loyalty, payroll) and lift ARPU as merchants push more transactions through a managed fleet. It's also a hedge against "tap-to-pay on phone" commoditizing the low end—Square can sell simplicity and durability to operators who don't want BYOD. Net-net: Square isn't abandoning software; it's tightening the hardware-software bundle to win bigger merchants, speed up checkouts, and defend share as the battle for the countertop moves into the aisle.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-aims-to-move-upmarket-with-handheld-pos-device/>

Article 6

Square opens the till to Bitcoin. Will small merchants bite?

Square is adding bitcoin payment capabilities to its checkout stack, giving small businesses a way to take crypto alongside cards and cash. It's a logical move for Block (Square's parent), which has long courted crypto users via Cash App and Jack Dorsey's pro-Bitcoin stance. What does it mean for merchants? Potentially a new customer segment, some cross-border appeal, and a bit of marketing sparkle. But real-world impact hinges on execution: will Square offer instant conversion to dollars (the common way to dodge price swings), clear tax/accounting tools, and simple refunds? Without that, volatility and bookkeeping headaches could outweigh the hype. For Square, it's a differentiation play—another feature to keep merchants inside its ecosystem and earn conversion or processing fees. For the industry, it's one more step toward normalizing crypto at the point of sale, though volumes remain modest and fees on the Bitcoin network can be spiky. Bottom line: this won't replace card rails anytime soon, but it lowers the experimentation cost for SMEs. If Square makes the UX painless, expect more "crypto accepted here" signs—more sizzle now, with steak depending on regulation and merchant demand.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-adds-bitcoin-payments-and-upgrades-ai-for-small-businesses/>

Square taps bitcoin at the till: Compass Coffee tests crypto payments

Coffee meets crypto. In DC, Compass Coffee took the first bitcoin payment via Square's new POS. It's a small swipe but a big signal: Block (Square's parent) is pushing bitcoin beyond investing into everyday commerce. For payment execs: If Square can make bitcoin as easy as tapping a card—handling price swings, taxes, and refunds behind the scenes—it could open a new acceptance lane without traditional card networks. Merchants might see lower fees and new customers, but they'll want instant USD settlement, clear reporting, and chargeback-like protections. Regulators will watch KYC, AML and tax treatment. This is a pilot, not a flip of the switch; the experience and economics will decide if more cafés follow. Still, with PayPal and Stripe dabbling in crypto, Square's move keeps it in the “rails innovator” conversation. If consumers start paying with bitcoin from their wallets as seamlessly as Apple Pay, acquirers and PSPs may need to rethink pricing, risk, and loyalty hooks. For now, it's one cappuccino; the question is whether it scales to the morning rush.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/squares-platform-sees-first-bitcoin-payment-at-coffee-shop/>

